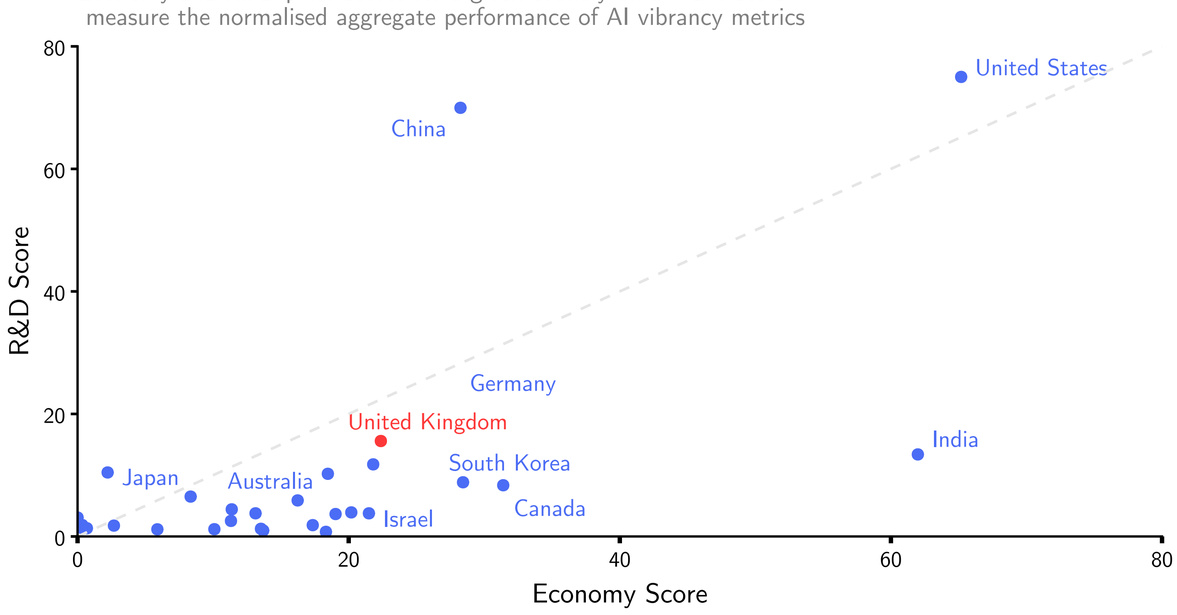
Where is the UK in the AI race?

Ellen Beattie Source: Global Artificial Intelligence Indicator Database (GAID) 1998-2025, sourced from the Harvard Dataverse

Economic Vibrancy

AI Vibrancy: Economy vs Research and Development by Country

Economy and R&D pillar scores for a given country on a 0-100 scale measure the normalised aggregate performance of AI vibrancy metrics

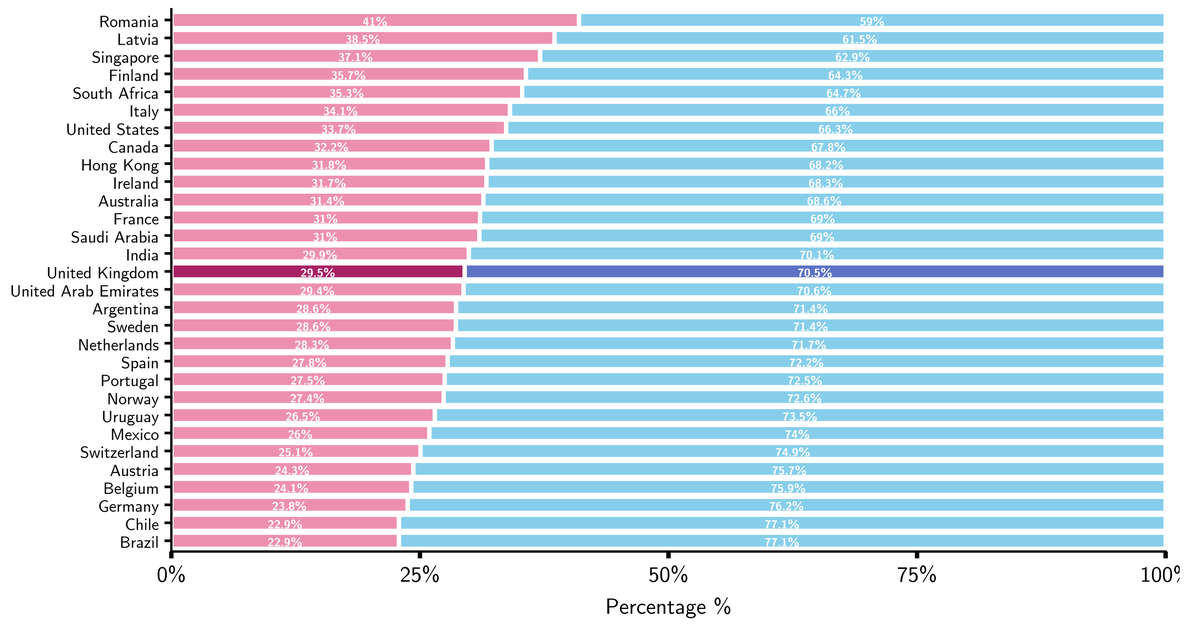


Source: Stanford AI Index - Global AI Vibrancy Tool (2021).
Economic score components include hiring intensity, newly funded companies, investment, skill penetration.
R&D score components include the number of AI journal/conference/public repository publications and citations and AI-related patents

When it comes to AI vibrancy in the Economy (capacity to exploit AI) and Research and Development (innovation capacity), the UK is one of the leaders of the chasing pack below the US, China and India.

2024 AI Talent Representation by Gender

Percentage of AI Specialists Identifying as Female versus Male



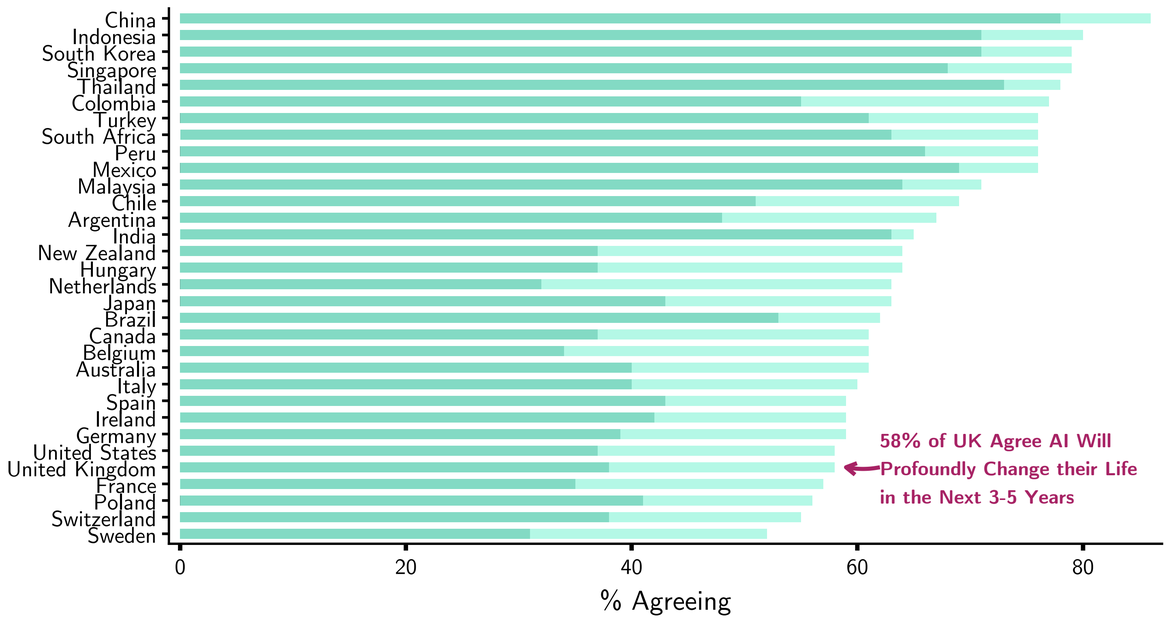
Source: Stanford AI Index - Economy,
Measures the share of the total AI workforce in a given country that identifies as female, indicating gender diversity within th

Women are under-represented in the AI workforce with only 29.5% of the UK AI specialists being female, which is broadly typical of a global issue of gender inequality in AI talent

Public Opinion

Impact of AI on Daily Life: Past and Future 3-5 Years

% Agreeing with Statement that AI has Profoundly Changed their Daily Life in the Past 3-5 Years and that it will in the Next 3-5 Years

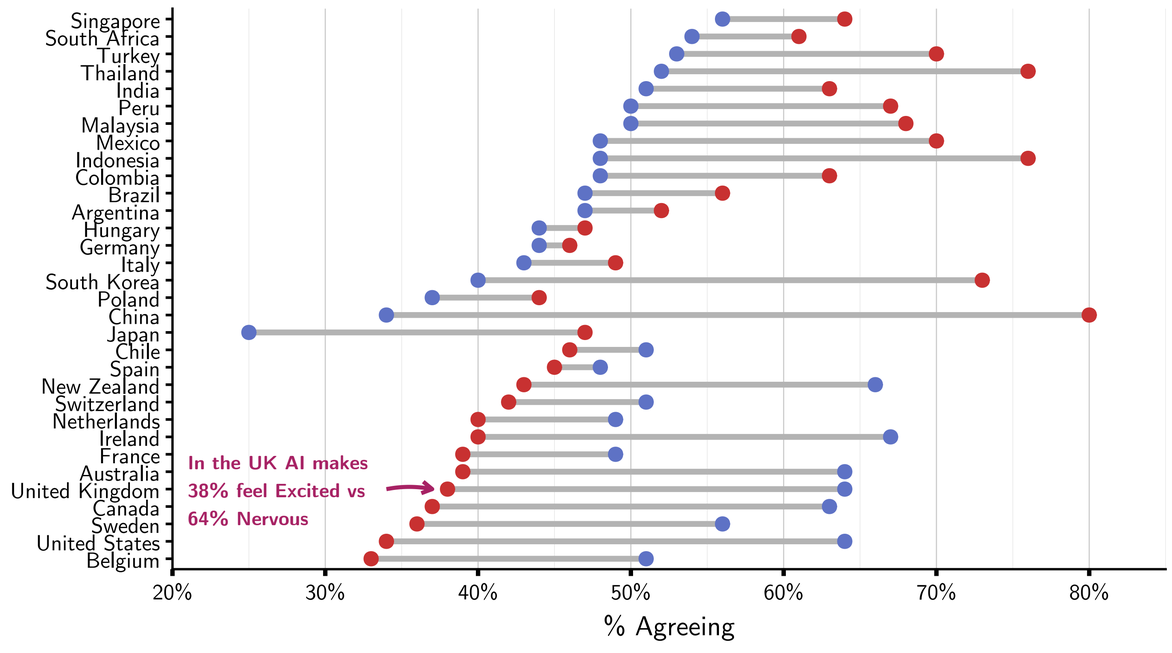


Source: Stanford AI Index - Public Opinion (2025). Measures the percentage of survey respondents in a given country who ex

Fewer people in the UK have felt that their life has been or will be drastically changed by AI compared with most other countries. China, Indonesia and South Korea lead as having the greatest percentage of people reporting and anticipating profound change to their daily lives because of AI.

Emotional Response to Using AI

% Agreeing with Statement that Products and Services using AI make them Excited or Nervous



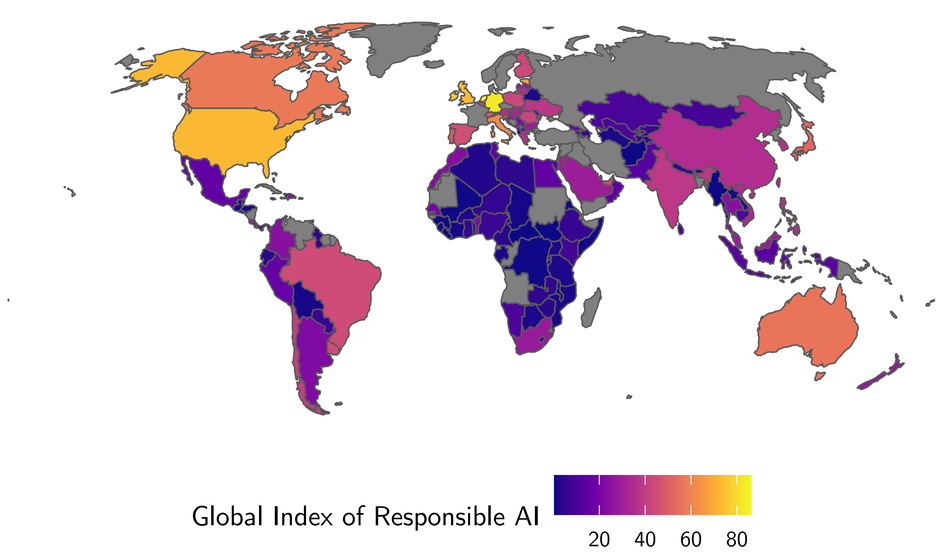
Source: Stanford AI Index - Public Opinion (2025). Measures National Average of Survey 'Yes' Responses to Statements

A substantially higher proportion of the UK public feel more nervous than excited about AI use, a trend seen across other European and North American nations. In other countries, especially those in Asia and South America, more people feel excited and less nervous about AI use.

Ethics and Responsible AI practices

2024 Global Index on Responsible AI Score

Measures the overall composite performance score (0-100) of a given country across all 185 dimensions and pillars of responsible AI practices and governance.

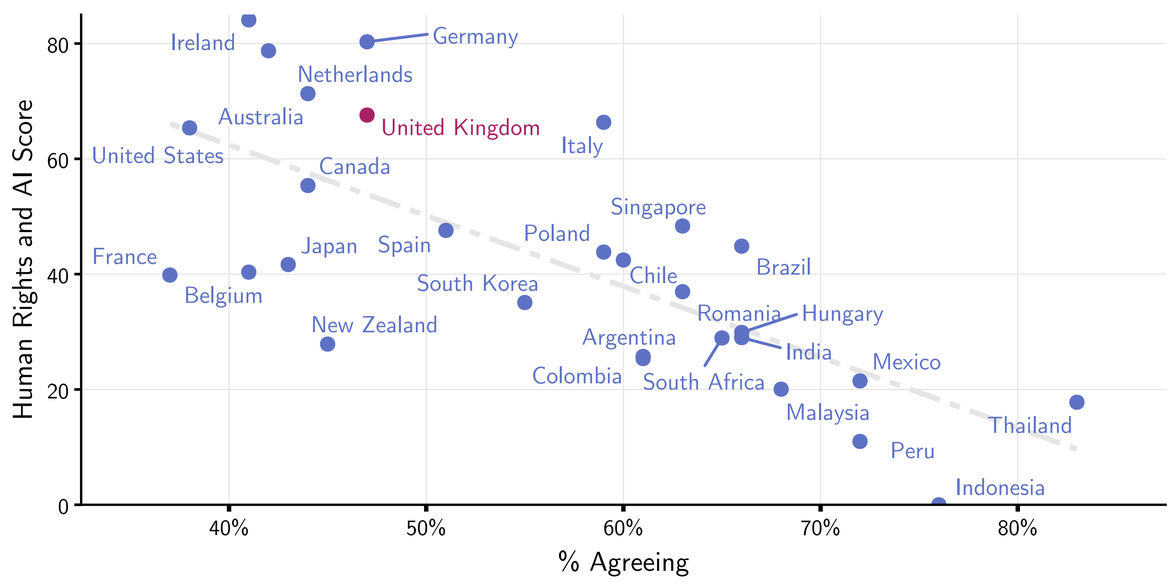


Source: Global Index on Responsible AI (GIRAI 2024).
Contributing to the score are Dimension on Human Rights and AI, Responsible AI Capacities and Governance, Government Actions and Frameworks and Non-state actor initiaives on Responsible AI

Western nations are leading globally as the most responsible in terms of AI practises and governance, with lower scores across South America, Africa and Asia. The UK falls just behind Germany and the Netherlands indicating they are enacting responsible AI initiatives, frameworks and policy to a reasonable extent.

Human Rights AI Score vs Public Trust in AI to Not Discriminate

Responsible AI score on Human Rights and AI vs % Agreeing with Statement
'I Trust Artificial Intelligence To Not Discriminate Or Show Bias Towards Any Group Of People'



Source: GIRAI Index 2024/ Stanford AI Index - Public Opinion (2024).
Dimension Score represents Country take steps to protect promote and respect human rights implicated by AI.
Agreement % Measures the percentage of survey respondents in a given country who expressed agreement with the specified statement

The UK has a moderately high Human Rights and AI score (>60) yet a less then half of the public surveyed said that they trusted AI to not discriminate or show bias. This is consistent with a general negative relationship between a higher public trust in AI to be non-discriminatory, and a lower human rights and AI score.